Training · Module 05 · Sat 14 Nov

Speak the owner's language.

The developer with less skill wins deals because he sounds like he's done it before. This primer gives you how each segment actually runs, where its money leaks, and the words owners use, so you sound like it too.

Time: 1 hour read + one field afternoon to verify it

Figures are rough rules of thumb. Always replace them with the owner's own numbers.

01 · DISTRIBUTORS AND WHOLESALERS

They don't sell goods. They manage credit and repeat orders.

How it runs	What you need to know
Salesmen and beats	Salesmen visit retailers on a fixed route ("beat" or "line") on fixed days and take orders on paper, phone or WhatsApp. Between visits, retailers often buy from a competitor.
Credit (उधारी)	Retailers usually get days or weeks of credit. Outstanding (आउटस्टँडिंग) and collection (वसुली) are the owner's biggest headache, often bigger than sales.
Schemes	Slab discounts and "buy 10 get 1" offers from brands. Retailers often don't know current schemes, so they don't order more.
Billing software	Tally, Busy and Marg (common in pharma) are typical. Orders get re-typed into billing by staff. Ask what they use: it decides integration scope.
Returns and expiry	Pharma and FMCG handle expiry returns; mistakes in orders mean returns and disputes.

The leaks to find: missed reorders between salesman visits · order typing errors · overdue credit · schemes nobody knows about · dependence on one salesman who "owns" the retailers. **What sells:** retailers order themselves 24×7, credit limits block risky orders automatically, schemes show in the app, a daily sales and outstanding report on the owner's phone.

02 · AUTO SPARE PARTS (YOUR TOP LEAD)

Garages want the right part, fast. Price comes third.

How it runs	What you need to know
Part numbers and fitment	The same part differs by make, model, year and variant. OEM part numbers and aftermarket brands both exist. A wrong part means a car stuck in the garage and a return. "Does it fit?" is the hardest data problem in this industry.
Who buys	Garages and mechanics buy several times a day, often while the vehicle is on the lift. Speed of delivery matters more than a small price difference.
Credit	Garages commonly buy on credit from parts shops and settle periodically. A prepaid-only app may struggle; ask the founder how he'll handle it.
Catalogue	Thousands of SKUs; fast movers (filters, brake pads, bulbs, clutch plates, oils) versus slow movers. Sellers' stock data usually sits in billing software or Excel, often messy.
Trust	Counterfeit parts are a real concern. Seller verification and brand authenticity build the marketplace's reputation.

Sound experienced by asking: "How will a garage know the part fits?" · "Delivery in how many hours?" · "Credit or prepaid?" · "Where does sellers' stock data live today?" · "Who handles wrong-part returns?"

03 · RESTAURANTS AND SWEET SHOPS

Own app for regulars. Aggregators for strangers.

How it runs	What you need to know
Aggregator cost	Commission plus ads and discounts can take a large share of each order (roughly 20–30% is a common owner estimate). Owners know this number by heart; ask for it.
Who uses an own app	Repeat local customers who already know the brand. Be honest: an own app doesn't replace Zomato/Swiggy for new customers.
Delivery	Some have their own delivery boys; others will need third-party hyperlocal delivery. Ask early: it changes the rider-app scope.
Peaks	Festivals (Diwali, Ganeshotsav, Sankranti) are huge for sweet shops: bulk and pre-orders are a strong feature.

What sells: no-commission ordering for regulars, WhatsApp order updates, festival pre-orders, loyalty points (your loyalty SaaS is direct proof here).

04 · SUPERMARKETS AND KIRANA CHAINS

Lock in local families before quick commerce arrives.

- Many already take orders by WhatsApp or phone, written by hand. Missed and wrong orders are common.
- Delivery is usually within a few kilometres; the top few hundred families drive most of the revenue.
- Quick-commerce apps are expanding into smaller cities; the owner's fear is losing regulars to them.
- What sells: an ordering app with the store's brand, WhatsApp order updates, loyalty points, stock synced with billing later.

05 · AGRI MARKETPLACES

Seasonal, credit-heavy, trust-driven.

- Inputs (seeds, fertilisers, pesticides) flow from companies to distributors to licensed dealers to farmers.
- Demand is seasonal around kharif (monsoon) and rabi (winter) sowing. A launch must land before a season, not during it.
- Farmers often buy on credit from dealers and repay after harvest. FPOs (farmer producer organisations) buy collectively.
- B2B (dealers ordering from distributors) is simpler to start; B2C (farmers) needs Marathi-first UI, trust and credit. Ask which comes first.

06 · BOOKING AND SERVICES (PET CARE)

Your strongest proof: you've built this already.

- Slots, verified providers, cancellations, ratings and payments, the same core as your European tour-booking marketplace.
- Recurring services (daily dog walks) fit subscriptions: predictable revenue, which founders love hearing about.
- Ask: how many providers are signed up? Who verifies them? What happens when a provider cancels?

07 · OWNER VOCABULARY

Words that make you sound like you've sat in their shop.

Word	Meaning	Use it like this
उधारी	Credit given	"उधारी किती दिवसांची देता?" (How many days of credit do you give?)
आउटस्टँडिंग	Pending dues	"सध्या मार्केटमध्ये किती आउटस्टँडिंग आहे?"
वसुली	Collecting dues	"वसुलीसाठी किती वेळ जातो?"
बीट / लाइन	Salesman route	"एका salesman कडे किती बीट आहेत?"
स्कीम	Brand offer / slab discount	"Retailers ना चालू स्कीम कशा कळतात?"
माल / स्टॉक	Goods / inventory	"माल संपला हे कधी कळतं?"
गिऱ्हाईक	Customer	"रोजचे गिऱ्हाईक किती आहेत?"
हिशोब	Accounts / the maths	"चला, एकदा हिशोब करू." (Let's do the maths once.)
नफा / तोटा	Profit / loss	"यात महिन्याला किती तोटा होतो?"
भांडवल	Capital	"यासाठी भांडवल तयार आहे का?" (for founders)

Field assignment: Saturday afternoon

☐ Visit two wholesale or spare-parts shops (find them on JustDial/IndiaMART or at Market Yard). Don't pitch. Say you're building ordering software and want to understand how orders come in.

☐ Ask three questions in each: how orders come in, how much credit is outstanding, what goes wrong most weeks.

☐ Write down the exact Marathi words they use. Add any new ones to this glossary.

☐ Bring one real insight to the spare parts founder's call: "I spoke to two parts shops this week, and they said…"

Pass mark: explain the money leak of each of the six segments in two sentences, without notes, when the CEO asks in chat.